TidyTuesday Week 43

Pranay Gundam

Saturday 24th October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we throw two unrelated economic time series into a blender, press the button, and act surprised at whatever sludge comes out. This week's lineup featured light-truck seasonal adjustment factors, Latin American fish prices, the minimum wage in our nation's capital, Midwestern gasoline, Japanese producer prices, and some discontinued data about how much cash the upper-middle-class keeps lying around. A real murderer's row of economic indicators that have absolutely no business being in the same room together. Naturally, we introduced them anyway.

Monday kicked us off with a resounding shrug. The seasonal factors for light truck production versus nonferrous metal export prices produced an R-squared of 0.00003, which is statistics-speak for "these two have never met and never will." The p-value was 0.93, a number so comfortably insignificant it could be framed and hung in a museum of things that don't matter. No trend to blame, no relationship to find, nothing collapsing when detrended because there was never anything standing in the first place. A beautiful, pure null result. We salute it. Tuesday wasn't much better: Latin American agriculture import prices and the cash holdings of the 50th-to-90th wealth percentile looked impressively linked in the raw regression (p-value 0.0006, dramatic gasp), but the moment we stripped out the shared time trend, the whole thing evaporated into a p-value of 0.86. Textbook trend mirage. Two series drifting along in the same general direction and fooling exactly nobody who bothered to look twice.

Then Thursday arrived with the week's headline act: the District of Columbia minimum wage versus the Peoria, Illinois house price index, posting a raw R-squared of 0.77 and a p-value with so many zeros it needed scientific notation to describe its enthusiasm. For one glorious moment you might think DC's wage floor is personally propping up the Peoria housing market. And then, as always, we detrend – and the relationship face-plants to a p-value of 0.91. Turns out both numbers just go up over time, like everything else in an economy, and that shared upward drift was doing all the heavy lifting. Another spectacular correlation reduced to rubble by the cruel arithmetic of a linear trend.

The one that actually survived came Friday: Midwest gasoline prices versus Japanese industrial producer prices. The raw regression was significant (no shock there), but it stayed significant even after detrending, with a p-value around 0.025. Is this the rare, interesting case? Possibly! Energy prices feeding into producer prices across the globe is at least a story a person could tell with a straight face at a dinner party. Or it's noise wearing a convincing costume. As always, the mandatory reminder: these are randomly paired series, none of this implies causation, and

drawing real conclusions from this project would be like reading tea leaves, except the tea is FRED and the leaves are a p-value. Spurious is the house style. See you next week.

2 Date: 2026-10-19

Series ID: G17MVSFWLTRUCKS
This series is titled Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors: Light Truck Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IY3314
This series is titled Export Price Index (NAICS): Nonferrous Metal (Except Aluminum) Production and Processing and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2005-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.008633
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.926
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1453.3
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2911.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2918.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	224.0975	50.852	4.407	0.000	123.938	324.257
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS	-0.0470	0.506	-0.093	0.926	-1.044	0.950

Omnibus:	96.948	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.011
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	270.714
Skew:	1.770	**Prob(JB):**	1.64e-59
Kurtosis:	6.683	**Cond. No.**	969.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

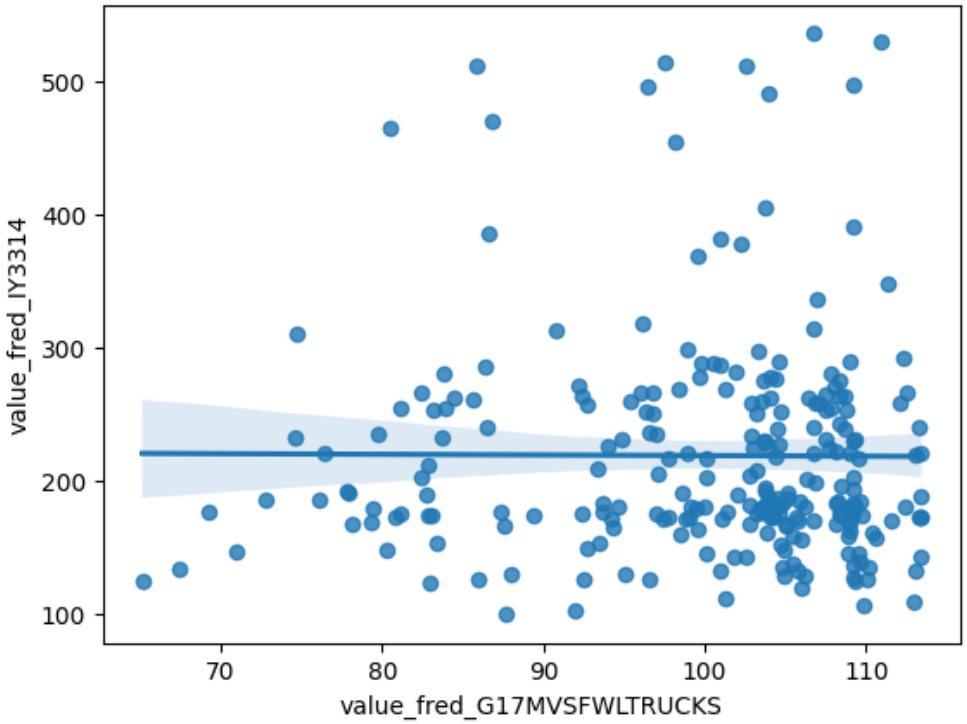


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.02068
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.886
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1346.8
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2698.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2705.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-6.754e-12	3.439	-1.96e-12	1.000	-6.774	6.774
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS_detrended	0.0475	0.330	0.144	0.886	-0.603	0.697

Omnibus:	75.189	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.024
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	174.874
Skew:	1.427	**Prob(JB):**	1.06e-38
Kurtosis:	5.952	**Cond. No.**	10.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

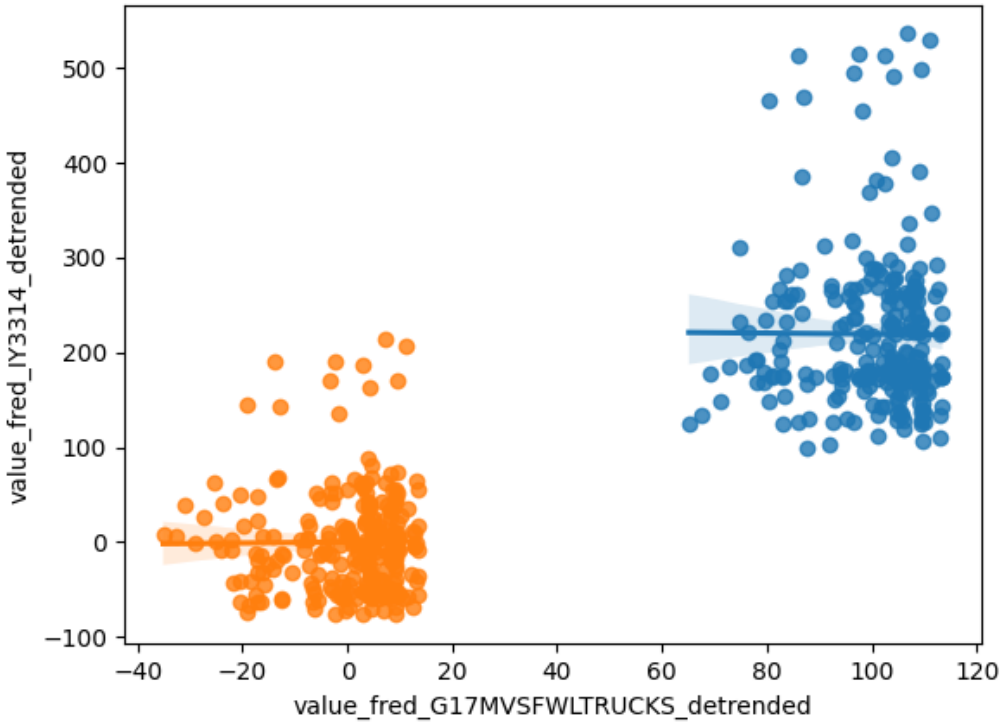


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

3 Date: 2026-10-20

Series ID: COLATZ11
This series is titled Import Price Index by Origin (NAICS): Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing and Hunting for Latin America and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jun 2012=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2012-06-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: WFRBLN40059
This series is titled Checkable Deposits and Currency Held by the 50th to 90th Wealth Percentiles (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1989-07-01 and the observation end date is 2022-04-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WFRBLN40059	**R-squared:**	0.267
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.248
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	13.87
Date:	Tue, 20 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.000635
Time:	15:55:02	**Log-Likelihood:**	-553.28
No. Observations:	40	**AIC:**	1111.
Df Residuals:	38	**BIC:**	1114.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.261e+06	4.72e+05	-2.672	0.011	-2.22e+06	-3.06e+05
value_fred_COLATZ11	1.62e+04	4349.040	3.724	0.001	7390.953	2.5e+04

Omnibus:	8.566	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.269
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	7.873
Skew:	1.067	**Prob(JB):**	0.0195
Kurtosis:	3.413	**Cond. No.**	1.28e+03

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.28e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

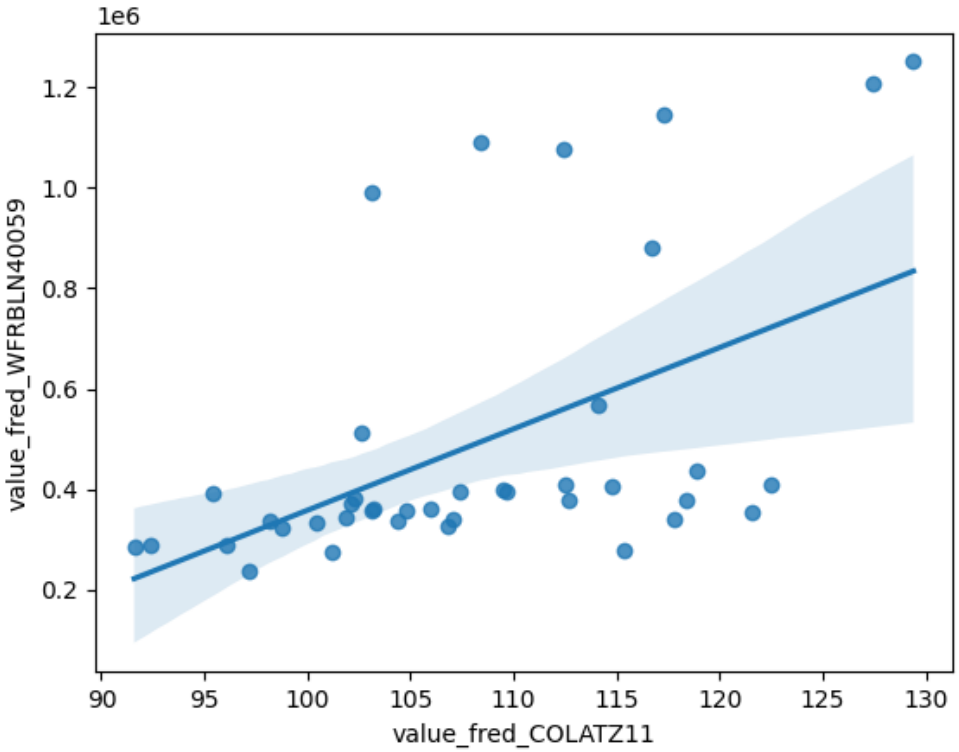


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-20

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WFRBLN40059_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.001
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.025
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.03202
Date:	Tue, 20 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.859
Time:	15:55:02	**Log-Likelihood:**	-543.18
No. Observations:	40	**AIC:**	1090.
Df Residuals:	38	**BIC:**	1094.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-5.959e-08	3.1e+04	-1.92e-12	1.000	-6.28e+04	6.28e+04
value_fred_COLATZ11_detrended	-859.3401	4802.520	-0.179	0.859	-1.06e+04	8862.854

Omnibus:	0.421	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.106
Prob(Omnibus):	0.810	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.579
Skew:	0.150	**Prob(JB):**	0.749
Kurtosis:	2.493	**Cond. No.**	6.46

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

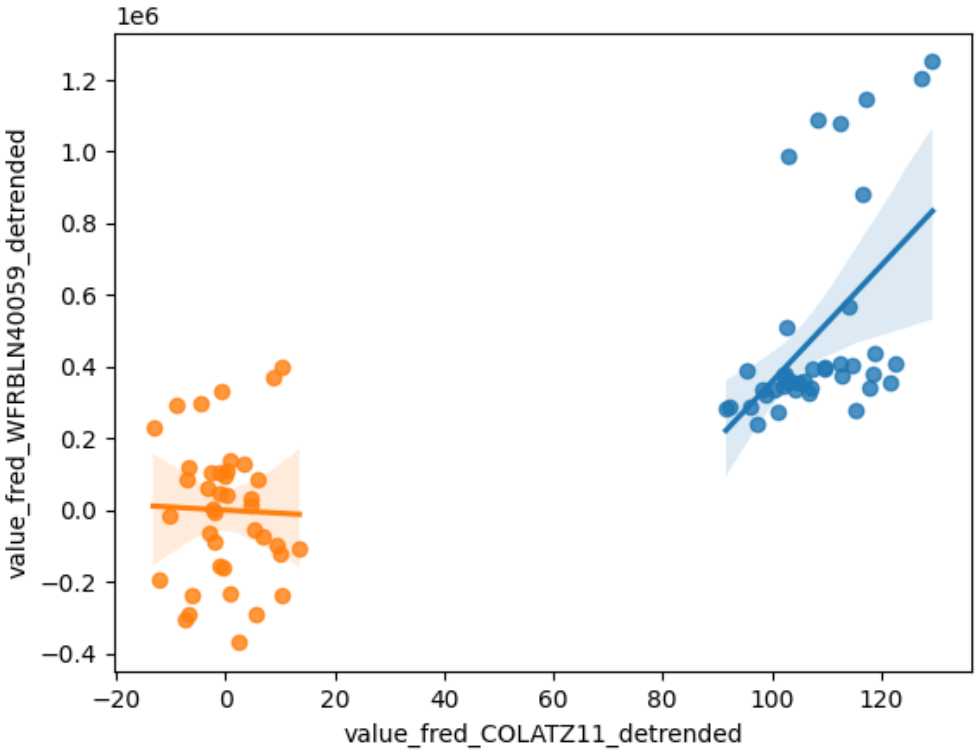


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-20

4 Date: 2026-10-23

Series ID: STTMINWGDC
This series is titled State Minimum Wage Rate for District of Columbia and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Dollars per Hour and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1968-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01.The popularity of this series is 21.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS37900Q
This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Peoria, IL (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1979-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS37900Q	**R-squared:**	0.773
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.768
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	153.3
Date:	Fri, 23 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	4.28e-16
Time:	15:59:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-215.63
No. Observations:	47	**AIC:**	435.3
Df Residuals:	45	**BIC:**	439.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	51.3736	7.417	6.926	0.000	36.434	66.313
value_fred_STTMINWGDC	10.0257	0.810	12.383	0.000	8.395	11.656

Omnibus:	16.895	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.093
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	3.651
Skew:	0.192	**Prob(JB):**	0.161
Kurtosis:	1.690	**Cond. No.**	19.3

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

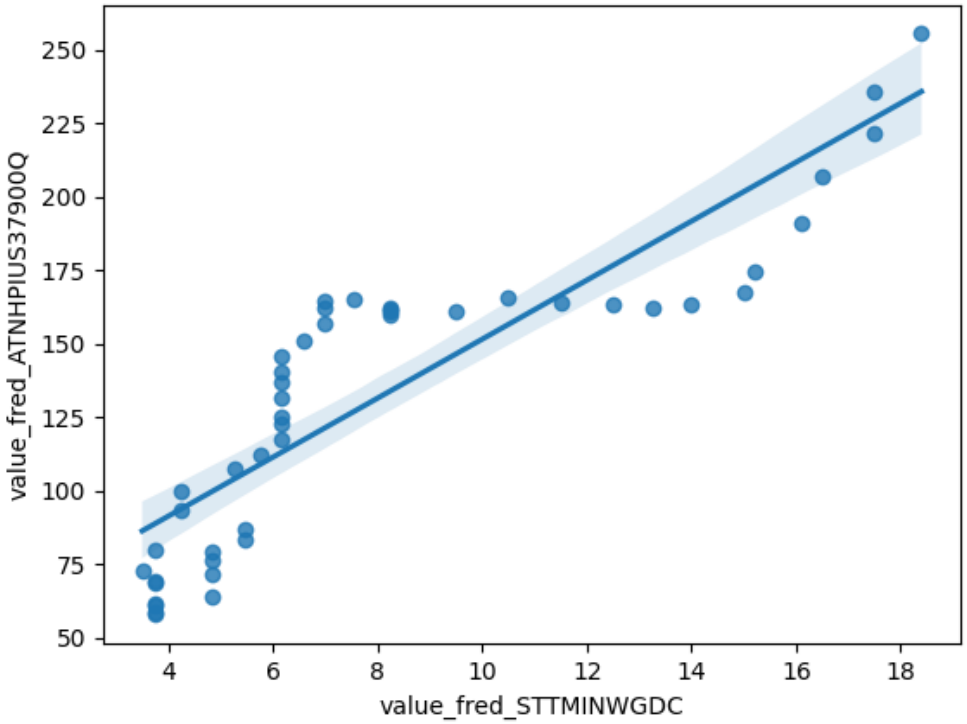


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-23

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS37900Q_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.022
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.01385
Date:	Fri, 23 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.907
Time:	15:59:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-191.61
No. Observations:	47	**AIC:**	387.2
Df Residuals:	45	**BIC:**	390.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.51e-14	2.127	7.1e-15	1.000	-4.283	4.283
value_fred_STTMINWGDC_detrended	0.1420	1.207	0.118	0.907	-2.288	2.572

Omnibus:	1.830	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.176
Prob(Omnibus):	0.400	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	1.367
Skew:	0.418	**Prob(JB):**	0.505
Kurtosis:	3.012	**Cond. No.**	1.76

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

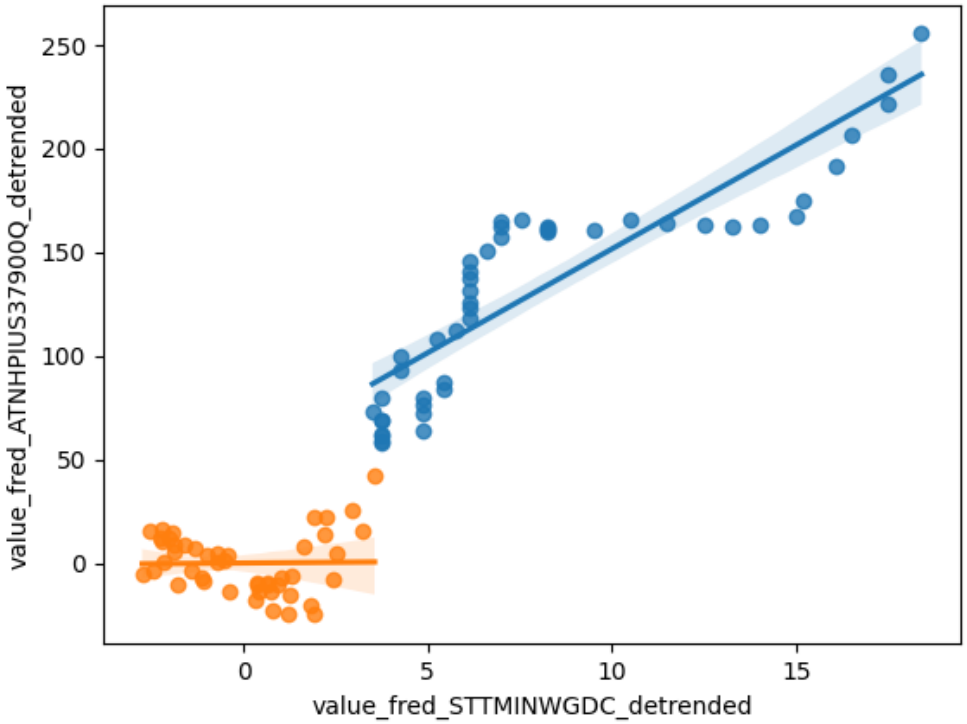


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-23

5 Date: 2026-10-24

Series ID: CUURX200SS47014
This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Gasoline, Unleaded Regular in Midwest - Size Class B/C and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1997=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1997-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: PIEATI02JPQ661N
This series is titled Producer Prices Index: Economic Activities: Industrial Activities: Domestic for Japan and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 2015=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1995-01-01 and the observation end date is 2022-10-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PIEATI02JPQ661N	**R-squared:**	0.131
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.122
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	14.73
Date:	Sat, 24 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.000220
Time:	14:58:05	**Log-Likelihood:**	-267.69
No. Observations:	100	**AIC:**	539.4
Df Residuals:	98	**BIC:**	544.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	96.1597	1.060	90.736	0.000	94.057	98.263
value_fred_CUURX200SS47014	0.0172	0.004	3.838	0.000	0.008	0.026

Omnibus:	39.712	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.070
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	82.712
Skew:	1.575	**Prob(JB):**	1.09e-18
Kurtosis:	6.150	**Cond. No.**	704.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

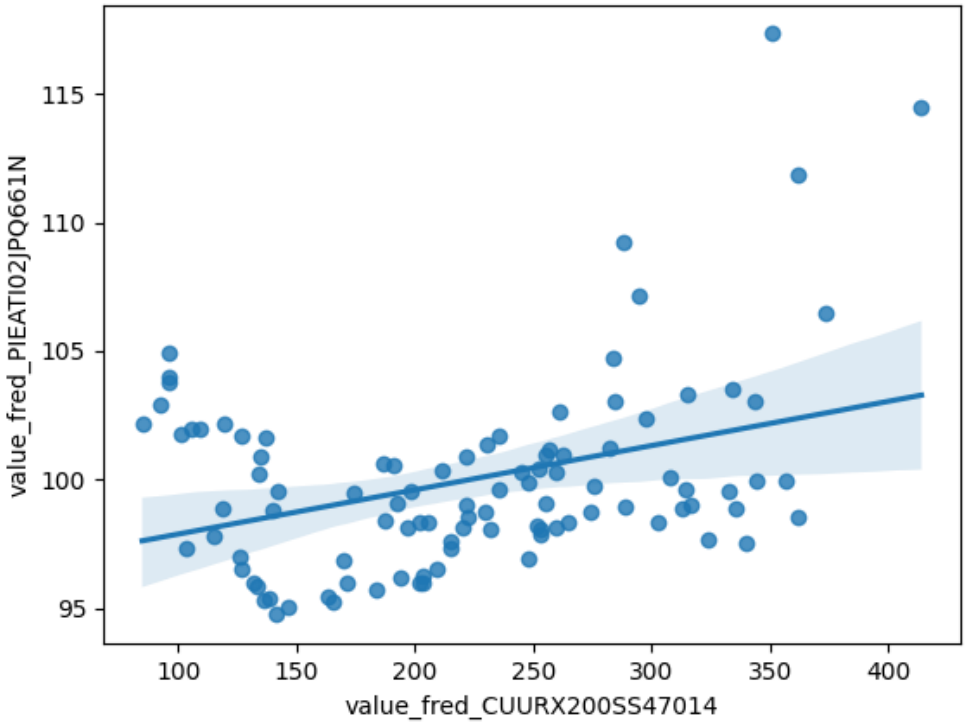


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-24

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PIEATI02JPQ661N_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.050
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.041
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	5.206
Date:	Sat, 24 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0247
Time:	14:58:05	**Log-Likelihood:**	-267.05
No. Observations:	100	**AIC:**	538.1
Df Residuals:	98	**BIC:**	543.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-3.933e-12	0.353	-1.11e-11	1.000	-0.701	0.701
value_fred_CUURX200SS47014_detrended	0.0131	0.006	2.282	0.025	0.002	0.025

Omnibus:	38.979	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.075
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	77.149
Skew:	1.582	**Prob(JB):**	1.77e-17
Kurtosis:	5.916	**Cond. No.**	61.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

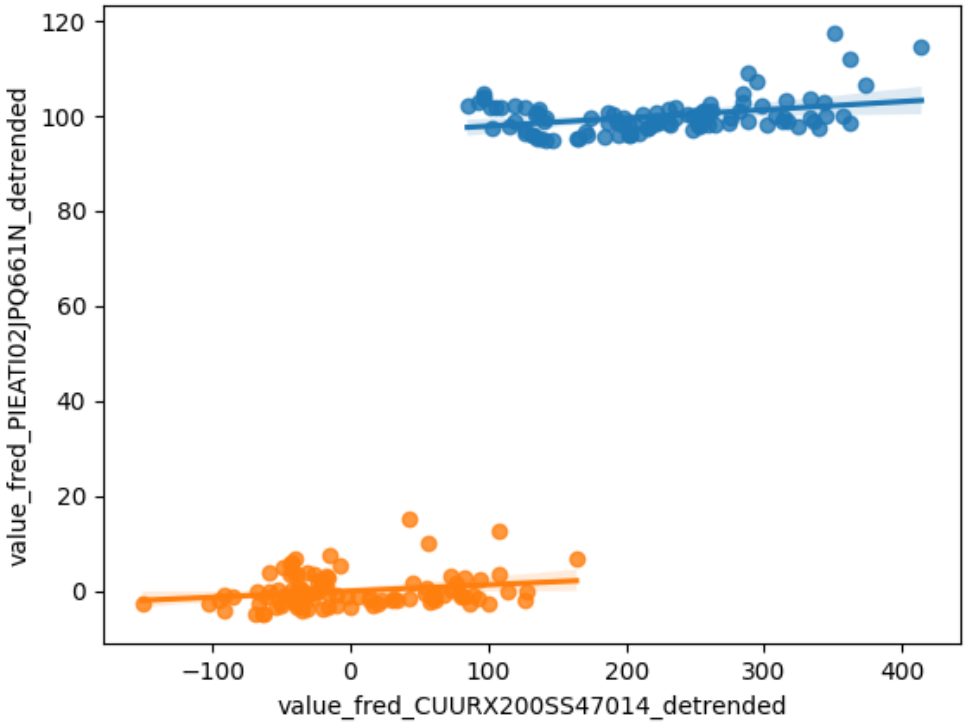


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-24